

Most didn't see THIS coming, whatever THIS is.

- What sounds sexy and looks good in a brochure or website is not what usually makes you money over the long run.
- You need a plan and the discipline to stick with it. EOM.
- “Nobody knows anything” is a truism about the future. It also applies to nearly everything in life. Internalize it.
- Your brain has evolved to keep you alive in changing conditions, not to make capital risk/reward decisions.
- Bull and bear markets have their own timelines. They do not care about your retirement, savings for your kid's college, or the new house you want to buy.
- “Uncertainty” is a misnomer. When you hear people using the word “uncertainty,” it is because they are scared enough to briefly acknowledge their own ignorance.
- Neither adrenaline nor dopamine is the basis of sound decision-making.
- All predictions are marketing (not advice).
- Boring, steady portfolios can withstand anything you throw at them.
- The future is inherently unknown and unknowable. Those who claim otherwise are selling something.
- Investing is hard.
- Sometimes, shit happens.

If you learn nothing else, at least learn this: Never confuse day-to-day noise with an actual reason to make a change in your portfolio. If you are merely reacting to the latest market action, then what you have is not a plan—you have instinctual, fear-driven behavior, and it's the makings of a disaster.

Or, as Blaise Pascal, the French mathematician and philosopher, once